

Wai Nui Gallery & Upload

How the photo & video system works — a plain-language overview

In plain terms

Members open a page on your website, pick photos or videos, add a caption and tags, and tap upload. The files go straight into your organization's OneDrive. The gallery page then displays them, reading directly from OneDrive. Members never need a Microsoft account or any login — they just use the link.

The step-by-step flow

- A member opens the **Upload** page on your website (the app appears inside your WordPress page).
- They choose photos/videos, type a caption, and tick tags.
- Their device uploads the files **directly to your OneDrive** — files do not pass through any other server.
- The caption and tags are attached to each file.
- The **Gallery** page reads from OneDrive and displays everything, newest first, organized by date.
- Tapping a photo shows it full-screen, with an option to download.

What pieces are involved, and what each does

Your website (WordPress / HostGator)	Hosts the two pages members see. The app is embedded inside them.
The app (hosted on Vercel)	The upload form, the gallery, and the admin settings page. Free hosting. Stores none of your photos.
Your OneDrive (Microsoft 365)	Where every photo and video actually lives — permanently. You own and control it directly.
Microsoft sign-in (Entra ID)	A one-time authorization that lets the app place files into your OneDrive. No member ever sees this.
Source code (GitHub)	Where the app's code is stored, so it can be updated and maintained.

Where your data lives — the important part

All photos and videos live in your OneDrive and nowhere else. The app keeps no separate copy and no separate database of your media. If the app were switched off tomorrow, every photo would remain safe in your OneDrive, exactly as uploaded. Deleting a file in OneDrive removes it from the gallery — the gallery is simply a window onto your OneDrive folder.

Files are organized automatically into dated folders (by year and month) so the OneDrive folder stays tidy as uploads grow.

Privacy & security

- Members upload without any account, but they cannot see or change anyone else's files — they only add their own.
- The connection to OneDrive is secured by a private key held only by the app's hosting, never shared with members or shown in the browser.
- The gallery is viewable by anyone with the page link (it's on your public website). It can be restricted to members only if ever needed.

Cost

Everything runs on free tiers: the hosting is free, the Microsoft authorization is free, and storage uses your existing OneDrive. There is no ongoing fee for the app.

Who controls what

Area	Controlled by
Your OneDrive / the files	You (the organization)
The tag list	Your admins, via the private settings page
App hosting, code & Microsoft authorization	Currently managed by your developer

Making changes

- **Tags:** you change these yourselves anytime on the admin settings page.
- **Anything else** (text, layout, features): handled by your developer.

This overview describes the system as currently set up. Photos and videos are stored in the organization's own OneDrive at all times.